

Employee Appreciation Email Templates

Fifteen situations, each with a specific-contribution structure, plus a recognition log

A specific piece of work

Subject: The [deliverable] was excellent Hi [Name], I read the [deliverable] this morning. The section on [specific] was exactly what [client / the team] needed, and the way you [specific thing they did] saved us [outcome]. Thank you. [Manager]

Going beyond the role

Subject: Thank you for stepping in Hi [Name], When [situation] happened on [day], you [what they did] without being asked, and it meant [outcome]. That is not in your job description and I noticed. Thank you. [Manager]

Hitting a target

Subject: [Target] hit [Name], [Number] against a target of [number]. You did that by [how], which is the part I want to recognise, because the number follows from it. Well done. [Manager]

Handling a difficult customer or situation

Subject: How you handled [situation] Hi [Name], I saw how you handled [customer / situation] yesterday. You stayed [calm / clear], you [what they did], and [outcome]. That is hard to do and you did it well. Thank you. [Manager]

Helping a colleague

Subject: Thanks for helping [colleague] Hi [Name], [Colleague] told me you spent [time] helping them with [thing]. That is the kind of thing that makes this a good team to be on. Thank you. [Manager]

Team thank-you after a project

Subject: [Project] is live. Thank you. Team, [Project] went live [when] after [duration]. [One sentence on what it delivers.] I want to name a few things: [Name] for [specific], [Name] for [specific], and everyone for [specific collective effort]. Take [Friday afternoon / a day] back this week. Thank you. [Manager]

Work anniversary

Subject: [N] years [Name], Today is [N] years since you joined. In that time you have [two specific contributions]. I am glad you are here. Thank you. [Manager]

Peer to peer

Subject: Thank you Hi [Name], Just a note to say thank you for [specific thing] last week. It made [my task / the project] much easier. I appreciated it. [Colleague]

From leadership to an individual

Subject: Your work on [thing] [Name], [Manager] told me about your work on [thing], and I looked at it myself. [Specific observation.] This is the standard we want, and I wanted you to hear that from me directly. Thank you. [Executive]

Remote team member

Subject: Noticed from here Hi [Name], Working remotely can mean good work goes unseen. Yours did not: [specific thing] on [day] was [outcome]. Thank you. [Manager]

Mentoring or onboarding a new hire

Subject: Thanks for looking after [new hire] Hi [Name], [New hire] is up and running faster than anyone expected, and they have said it is because of you. Thank you for the time you put in; it is an investment in the whole team. [Manager]

Improving a process

Subject: The new [process] Hi [Name], Your change to [process] has [measured effect: cut X from Y to Z]. That is the kind of improvement that compounds. Thank you for spotting it and for doing the work to make it stick. [Manager]

Client praise passed on

Subject: [Client] said this about you Hi [Name], [Client] wrote today: "[quote]". I wanted you to see it in their words. Thank you for the work behind it. [Manager]

Consistent reliability

Subject: Thank you for being reliable Hi [Name], Reliability does not get thanked often because it looks like nothing happening. [Specific: every report on time this quarter, every handover complete.] It is noticed and it matters. Thank you. [Manager]

Thank-you with a reward

Subject: Thank you, and something small Hi [Name], [Specific contribution and outcome.] As a thank-you, [reward: a day off on a date of your choosing / a gift card / lunch on the company]. [Name] in HR will arrange it. Thank you. [Manager]